SS-C-161A
January 23, 1974
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. SS-C-161
February 7, 1933 and
Int. Fed. Spec. SS-P-00410A
December 21, 1966

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CEMENT: KEENE'S

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers Keene's cement, anhydrous calcined gypsum, for plastering.

1.2 Classification. Keene's cement shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I - Standard-Setting
Type II - Quick-Setting

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specification:

UU-S-48 - Sacks, Shipping, Paper.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standard:

C 61 - Specification for Keene's Cement.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Freight Classification Committee Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Both types of Keene's cement shall meet the chemical and physical requirements of ASTM C 61 (see 4.4).

3.2 Workmanship. Keene's cement shall be dry, and free from lumps and extraneous particles.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Lot. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), a lot shall consist of each type of cement submitted for inspection at the same time.

4.2.2 Visual examination of end item. Samples for visual examination shall be selected in accordance with level S-3 in MIL-STD-105.

4.2.3 Samples for test. The number of samples for tests shall be in accordance with the applicable ASTM test methods referenced in ASTM C 61.

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 End item. Keene's cement shall be examined for defects listed in table I. The Acceptable Quality Levels (AQL's) for defects shall be 2.5 percent defective for major defects and 4.0 percent defective for minor defects.

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TABLE I. Classification of defects, end item

Defects	Major	Minor
Lumps in cement		X
Cement not dry	X	
Extraneous particles in cement	X	
Damage or defects not affecting function or serviceability		X

4.3.2 Inspection of preparation for delivery. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing and marking requirements comply with section 5 of this specification.

4.4 Test methods.

4.4.1 Acceptable quality level. The AQL for tests shall be 4.0 percent defective.

4.4.2 Chemical analysis and physical properties. Chemical analysis and physical properties shall be tested in accordance with ASTM C61 (see 3.1).

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. The plaster furnished in 50 or 100 pound quantities as specified (see 6.2), shall be packed in a sack conforming to UU-S-48. Top closure shall be in accordance with the requirements specified in the sack specification.

5.1.2 Level B. The plaster furnished in 50 or 100 pound quantities as specified (see 6.2), shall be packed as specified in 5.1.1.

5.1.3 Level C. The plaster shall be packed in accordance with the suppliers commercial practice and to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination, in containers at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Shipping containers shall conform with the Uniform Freight Classification Rules or National Motor Freight Classification Rules, as applicable.

5.2 Marking.

5.2.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the sacks shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.2.2 Military activities. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the sacks shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.

6.1.1 Type I, standard setting. Type I Keene's cement is intended for use as a gaging material with lime and sand for the scratch and brown coats of plastering, and also for use either neat with the addition of water only, or gaged with lime putty for the finish coat of plaster.

6.1.2 Type II, quick setting. Type II Keene's cement is intended for use as a gaging with not less than 25 pounds of dry hydrated lime per 100 pounds of Keene's cement for finish coat of plaster. This type is intended for use where a finish plaster is desired which sets more rapidly than the standard Keene's cement, as indicated by type I.

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6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options offered herein and include the following in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Type (see 1.2).
(c) Size of lot, if different from 4.2.1.
(d) Selection of applicable level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1).
(e) Quantity of plaster required (see 5.1.1 and 5.1.2).

MILITARY CUSTODIANS:

(DOD coordination has been waived)

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:

COMMERCE-NBS
HUD-TCS
USDA-AFS

Orders for this publication are to be placed with the General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price - cents each.

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